

[Return to Search](#)

How a Hawiye tribe used to live

Author(S): Cerulli, Enrico, Biancani, Piero

Document Type: Essay

Original Page: 87

Culture (OWC): [Somali \(M004\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Eastern Africa

Field Date: 1919-1922

Coverage Date: 1919-1922

Place Coverage

Hawiye; Somalia, Djibouti, and southeastern Ethiopia

Section Title(S)

8. The Abg[unknown]al and the tradition of Sal[unknown]ama, the Negress.

Son of my mother Sal[unknown]amo.
your thumbs are like that! (²)

000
Material Not Relevant

"So he said. The thumbs of the nobles are straight. The thumbs of the Negroes are curved. An Abg[unknown]al who heard the distich said: 'You have called me son of your mother and why then do you offend me (³)?' So it was said.

113
[Bibliographies In Sources](#)

173
[Traditional History](#)

539
[Literary Texts](#)

829
[Ethnosociology](#)

"In this country in which the Abg[unknown]al are living, the A[unknown]gur[unknown]an used to live. When the A[unknown]gur[unknown]an emigrated, the Dugodiya settled down there. When the Dugodiya emigrated, I do not know where they went (⁴). ■ 88 In the territory in which they used to live, the Wa'[unknown]eslä are living now (⁵). The Abg[unknown]al formerly lived at the well of Dam'ay-ror. They emigrated from there and settled in the place called Dirin. Then they settled in the place

131
[Location](#)

167
[External Migration](#)

173
[Traditional History](#)

called W[unknown]arga[unknown]d[unknown]de. Now the Wa'[unknown]jeslä live by the well of Dam'ay-ror. Near it is W[unknown]arga[unknown]d[unknown]de, where the Eybeker G[unknown]abanä now drink" (⁶).

539
Literary Texts

. The Garmagalä, 'freed,' jokes about the tradition of Sal[unknown]amo in order to call his brothers and Negroes, therefore, like him, the proud Abg[unknown]al pastoralists.

. For an analogous reply to a similar offense, cf. my Folkliterature of the Galla of Southern Abyssinia, Cambridge, Mass., 1922 ("Harvar Africana Varia," III), p. 191.

. The Dugodiya, at the beginning of the XX century, were reduced to a small community in the lower valley of the [unknown]Dawa, affluent of the Giuba /Juba/, above [unknown]Dol[unknown]o. The memory that the tradition preserves here is important: that of their ancient presence in the zone between the sea and the W[unknown]jebi, from where they were chased by the successive emigrations, like so many other tribes.

. The Wa'[unknown]jeslä are an Abg[unknown]al tribe of pastoralists now along the coast of the Indian Ocean, with a center at Mär[unknown]jeg.

. The Eybeker G[unknown]abanä are also Abgäl and are found between the Indian Ocean and the river, to the east and southeast of Mahaddäy-W[unknown]jen.

Human Relations Area Files

755 Prospect Street

New Haven, CT 06511

General Inquiries: ✉ hraf@yale.edu

Issues and Bugs: ✉ hraf-support@yale.edu



[Terms and Conditions](#) · [Accessibility](#) · [Cookie Policy](#)